

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam

Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet



This facility is a boon to women from many an interior street in Chintadripet.

PHOTOS: RAGU R

Vineetha says women in the area had earlier depended largely on walking at May Day Park for physical activity.

Jennifer notes the gym had added variety to their routines. "Usually, we were only walking. Stationary cycling brings an air of novelty to our exercise routine," she elaborates.

She adds that exercising outdoors often required residents to begin early in the morning before the heat intensified. "Walking in May Day Park would require us to head there early before the sun gets intense. The gym gives us the option of exercising a little later in the day. There is also privacy here," Jennifer points out.

Sonam, from Coimbatore and currently visiting her parents at Padavattamman Street, observes the facility has enabled her to maintain continuity in her regular fitness regimen. "In Coimbatore, I would hit the gym regularly. Quick access to this facility means there is continuity to my fitness routine," notes Sonam.

The gym will see wider operations once evening operations begin, especially among working women unable to visit during morning hours.

R. RAGU

At this community gymnasium in Chintadripet for women, functionality pulls its weight. Luxury does not quite keep pace with functionality, but no one is complaining.

With murals displaying women in workouts, the ambience draws the eye without going over the top. Though compact, the gym comes with sufficient space, further enhanced by a mirror, not one stretching from roof to floor, the kind encountered at every turn in commercial gyms, but large enough to provide a sense of expansiveness. The flooring seems to have been designed for safety, being slip-resistant. Being seating-based, the fitness work station is suitable even for elderly users. Among the notable fitness equipment are stationary exercise bikes, an elliptical cross-trainer and a cable machine.

And one look at the composition of the people visiting this Greater Chennai Corporation-run, women's gym at Vedagiri Street in Chintadripet, and the question of inclusivity gets decisively settled. The age band of the visitors is wide; there are home makers whose day never gets done; the elderly, who have settled into quiet retirement; and even working women, who troop into

Women pump iron in Chintadripet

The women-centric gym at Vedagiri Street is enjoying steady patronage. Currently operational only in the morning hours, it is expected to help a greater number of working women when its doors stay open in the evening as well



the gym in the early opening hours, spend a few minutes for fitness and rush back home to get ready for office.

Gyms always provide a space for banter; but this one specialises in neighbourhood banter. Freezing one frame, this photojournalist got to interact with three women who were from the streets that are neighbours to Vedagiri Street. Vineetha (aged 46), a resident of Iyya Street. Jennifer (aged 31), a resident of Padavattamman Street. So-

nam, also 31 years old and staying at Padavattamman Street, is visiting her parents, long-time residents of that street in Chintadripet.

This gym is turning out to be a valued community facility for women residents across the neighbourhood, enabling them to take fewer steps to access a fitness space, but cover considerable ground in terms of good health. Located in Ward 62 which comes under Royapuram Zone of Greater Chennai Corporation, the gym's

establishment was made possible by funds from the councillor's allocation. The total cost of project is ₹46 lakh.

At present, the facility operates from 6.30 a.m. to 10.30 a.m.; evening hours are expected to be introduced in the future, expanding access for working women and students.

The gym is now being managed temporarily by Corporation staff member Muthamma. After completing her morning responsibil-

ities at the gym, she continues her work day at the ward office. This arrangement would be in place till the appointment of a full-time caretaker. When that happens, the gym's doors would be open in the evening hours too.

On an average, 15 women would be using the facility every day, visiting at timings convenient to them.

The gym has filled an important gap by offering an accessible and private space for exercise in the neighbourhood.

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The recreational space has received a facelift carried out by Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority. Among the highlights is a science zone with models depicting various laws of physics

L.KANTHIMATHI

Amma Park, a prominent landmark on Kodambakkam Road in West Saidapet, which was undergoing an eight-month-long renovation, carried out by Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority at a cost of ₹2.6 crore, is ready for reopening.

Regular visitors will be greeted by a new landscape. As part of the facelift, it has received the following amenities: badminton court, skating rink, and the gazebo meant for Yoga have been made bigger.

A fountain is an additional feature. The play area for children and outdoor gym have been provided with new equipment.

A boxing court is a fresh addition.

A zone for science is another highlight: here, one would find models demonstrating various laws and concepts of physics. They include energy conservation in hydroelectric power plants, Kepler's

Residents seek reopening of *Amma Park* in West Saidapet



Amma Park on Kodambakkam Road in West Saidapet on May 21, 2026.

Law of Planetary Motion, conversion of kinetic energy into electrical energy through a bicycle, and the arithmetical concept of fraction. There is also a model depicting Indian Space Research Organi-

sation's rocket.

New toilets have been built, and one of them has been dedicated for the differently-abled.

Residents of the neighbourhood are eagerly awaiting the reopening

of the park.

"Everything looks set and ready. There is no sign of work at the park for the past couple of months. We request the officials to reopen the park at the earliest," says a resident

of West Saidapet.

It will be inaugurated in less than a month, say CMDA officials. The park falls under Ward 140 in Zone 10 - Kodambakkam. It was first inaugurated in 2016.

Sivan park gets a gallery and new play equipment

The images show the new amenities at Sivan Park on P.V. Rajamannar Salai in K.K. Nagar. Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority carried out a renovation work at the park in the last seven months at an approximate cost of ₹4 crore. The work was completed two months ago. However, the park remained open for use during the renovation work.

As part of the work, the recreational space has been provided with a gallery, a skating rink and an additional badminton court. Further, the play equipment have been replaced with new ones. The entire footpath has been re-laid with new tiles. The images were taken on May 21, 2026.



Sivan Park on P.V. Rajamannar Salai in K.K. Nagar on May 21, 2026.

Residents losing property or educational documents face protracted bureaucratic procedures before securing non-traceable certificates required for getting duplicate copies

LIFFY THOMAS

In Chennai, 20-25 Non-Traceable Certificates are issued a month by the Police Department, the list generally released on Thursdays. Sought by those who have lost any original property-related document or misplaced an educational certificate that cannot be traced, getting a Non-Traceable Certificate serves as an official document in such cases.

The Certificate is required to be submitted to apply for a duplicate copy to get claims and for other government-related transaction or to prevent any fraud.

In April 2022, then Director General of Police, C. Sylendra Babu, issued a circular listing out various guidelines that should be followed by the petitioner while seeking such a certificate, along with timelines that should be followed by the police department as well.

Many a time, the entire exercise extends for months with various departments including police station in the petitioner's area of jurisdiction, Sub Registrar Office and Central Crime Record Bureau in the picture.

Documents to submit

The petitioner is required to furnish certified copies of the documents that are lost (obtained within a month prior to the presentation of the petition at the police station from the Sub Registrar Office concerned). Along with this, a recent photograph of the petitioner, a copy of the Aadhar Card, Voter ID or Passport; and newspaper advertisements placed in an English and a vernacular paper are to be submitted.

In case of death of the legal owner of the property, his or her legal heir should present the petition along with death certificate issued by a local body and legal heir certificate issued by designated Revenue Authority.

An encumbrance certificate for the property in question, for the last 20 years or from the date of registra-

The chase around missing documents



ILLUSTRATION:
SATHEESH VELLINEZH

tion of missing document, obtained from the Sub Registrar office, must also be furnished.

The petitioner is also required to submit an undertaking along with the petition that if the missing document is traced later, the Station House Officer (SHO) will be intimated who in turn has to inform the Sub Registrar Office.

Once an application is submitted, the Station House Officer (SHO) issues a CSR to the petitioner.

Later, a letter addressed to the Deputy Superintendent of Police/Assistant Commissioner of Police of the DCRB/CCRB is sent informing loss of document along with a certificate.

This is followed by publishing the matter in Crime and Occurrence Sheet within a week from the date of receipt of the letter from the SHO.

The circular insists all police stations to paste it on its notice board and state police website and CCTNS citizen portal to post the circular.

Applications for issuing a Non-Traceable Certificate are also accepted online.

'A process that consumes time, induces tedium'

C.B. PAUL CHELLAKUMAR

From my own experience, I can say the procedures involved in getting a Non-Traceable Certificate is tiring, time-consuming and tedious.

I been running around for the last nine months to get the Certificate (CSR No 778 2025) despite producing all supporting documents.

Three officers who were handling my case were transferred and I am back to square one. Now, the new police officers at Thirumangalam Police Station who have taken charge are asking all the documents again as

those filed with the officers are not found. I cite this experience not to meet my ends but to help other petitioners who will be desperately running behind these three agencies, namely the Station House Officer (SHO), Commissioner of Police Office (CPO) and Sub-Registrar's Office (SRO).

The current system must be amended. For instance, the petitioner may be directed to file their petition with the Magistrate Court with all supportive documents, which could then be forwarded to the police station concerned, with proper instructions for action and report within a stipulated time. The magistrate on receipt of the re-

port with all supportive documents can issue the 'Non Traceable Certificate' instead of the SHO doing it.

General information on the procedures and documents required should be made available with every police station. The police personnel at stations are not familiar with the procedures and need proper orientation. The officer should also give acknowledgement for the documents received from the complainant as supportive documents for the loss of property documents also get lost at the police stations.

C.B. Paul Chellakumar is a resident of 13th Main Road, Anna Nagar

An elusive honour for a freedom fighter

Activists seek to name a knowledge centre after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper; bust awaits official clearance for installation

T. ARVIND

A bust of freedom fighter Parali Su. Nellaiyapper, a close associate of Subramania Bharathi and V.O. Chidambaram Pillai, remains wrapped and awaiting installation at a memorial-cum-library premises in Chromepet, even as activists continue to seek official recognition for his contributions.

The premises, located in Tambaram Corporation's Ward 25, now functions as a Knowledge and Study Centre. Residents and activists have urged the civic body to attach the freedom fighter's name to the renovated facility and formally unveil his bust, which has been ready for installation since March this year.

Donated land

Parali Su. Nellaiyapper, a poet, philanthropist and freedom fighter, lived in Chromepet during the 1950s. In recognition of his services to the nation, the State government allotted him more than three acres of land in 1954. In 1968, he donated over two grounds of land for establishing a primary school for children from economically weaker sections.

The Parali Su. Nellaiyapper Municipal Primary School functioned for several years before becoming defunct by the late 1990s owing to a shortage of teachers and staff.

Over the years, the premises fell into disrepair, with the abandoned campus turning into a hub for anti-social activities. Residents and activists later initiated efforts to restore the property for public use.

Campaign for restoration

According to activist S. Meenakshisundaram, efforts to revive the school began in 1996 and gathered momentum after the forma-



tion of the Senior Citizen Welfare Association, Chromepet East, in 2015.

Association members conducted Independence Day and Republic Day celebrations at the premises and campaigned for its restoration. "Cases were filed against us claiming trespassing when we tried to maintain the premises and conduct public events," Meenakshisundaram said.

A major breakthrough came in 2022 when the then Pallavaram Municipality sanctioned ₹1 crore for redevelopment of the site. However, activists opposed proposals to convert the premises into a waste segregation facility or a veterinary clinic, insisting that the land should continue to serve educational purposes in keeping with the freedom fighter's vision.

Following sustained campaigns, including poster protests in 2023 over non-utilisation of funds, the Tambaram Corporation Knowledge and Study Centre was opened in January 2024.



Activist S. Meenakshisundaram points to the pedestal awaiting the installation of freedom fighter's bust at the Knowledge and Study Centre in Chromepet; and (below) Parali Su. Nellaiyapper. PHOTOS: T. ARVIND AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Demand for recognition

Activists say the civic body is yet to accept their demand to rename the facility after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper.

"The Knowledge Centre was established on land donated by the freedom fighter. It is only appropriate that the centre bears his name," Meenakshisundaram said.

Efforts were also taken to install a bust of the freedom fighter at the premises. Former MLA E. Karunanidhi contributed around ₹1 lakh towards the in-

itiative, and the bust was sculpted in Mahabalipuram.

However, the installation has reportedly been delayed following disagreements over accommodating another leader's statue at the site. Though the pedestal was widened to house two busts, the second statue is yet to be completed, leaving Parali Su. Nellaiyapper's bust and portrait inside the centre.

Meenakshisundaram recently met Tambaram Corporation Commissioner S. Balachandran and appealed for early clearance to unveil the bust.

Role in freedom movement

Parali Su. Nellaiyapper worked as an accountant in the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company founded by V.O. Chidambaram Pillai. Activists say he also played a key role in helping Subramania Bharathi relocate to Pudukcherry, then under French rule, to escape British persecution.

He is further remembered for assisting Bharathi's family in conducting the poet's last rites in Triplicane.

At present, nearly 100 students and youth use the Knowledge and Study Centre daily, including for NEET coaching classes. Activists are also planning to seek support from IIT-Madras for donating books to the centre.

Despite years of struggle to restore the premises, activists say their demand remains simple – that the centre be named after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper and that his bust be formally unveiled in honour of his contribution to society and the freedom movement.

Rotary District 3233 along with a smart educational learning platform is offering a free NEET online test practice series in Tamil and English before the retest on June 21

LIFFY THOMAS

Many students have returned to coaching institutes after the National Testing Agency cancelled the NEET 2026 held on May 3 and inked in a retest for June 21. One would be lucky if the institute they have associated with in the last one to two years is only charging a nominal fee or no fee at all for this additional period.

A neat solution



Students at a centre in College on May 3. PHOTO: RAGU R

For those who cannot afford to get back to the classroom and need some quick help with question banks and test papers, here is a platform that comes free of cost.

QB365, a smart educational learning platform, with the support of Rotary District 3233, has launched a free NEET online test

practice series for students in Tamil Nadu.

The initiative aims to help students regain confidence, reduce examination fear, improve exam readiness, and continue their preparation in a positive and structured manner.

According to a press release, Ta-

mil Nadu has one of the highest NEET candidates appearing, with approximately 1.55 lakh students registered for NEET UG 2026. A significant number of students are from rural backgrounds, Tamil-medium schools, and from economically weaker sections who find it difficult to get accessible and affordable academic support.

Purushothaman, a Rotary member and founder of QB365, says they have uploaded 14,000 questions along with answers in all the three subjects in both Tamil and English.

This also includes question papers from previous years and other sample papers based on NCERT syllabus.

He says the platform will be

helpful for students who cannot afford to spend money until the NEET retest but at the same time want to stay updated on what they have learnt. "We are not a coaching institute or tutors but we offer practice exams," he says.

Once a person logs in there are topic wise test papers. A person need to upload their NEET hall ticket to get access to the test papers.

Besides daily and weekly NEET practice tests with mobile-friendly online access, the platform would also give a performance analysis based on the scores.

Rotarian P. Jayanathan, Chennai coordinator and RI District -Additional Director, says the 30-day course will also offer instant results. Last year, Rotary had a similar tie-up with the educational platform but was charging students a small fee. This year, we are offering it free seeing the stress that students are undergoing with retest and to keep their medical dream alive, says Jayanathan.

At a glance

Website:

www.qb365.in

Key features:

daily and weekly NEET practice tests, topic-wise tests



Members of Poonga View RWA which represents TP Scheme Road have a request for CM Vijay

The squalor marking one side of TP Scheme Road. PHOTOS: PRINCE FREDERICK



Not the view they had bargained for

PRINCE FREDERICK

Poonga View Residents Welfare Association: when they christened their RWA thus, residents of TP Scheme Road in Mandaveli had in mind categories of "views" diametrically opposite to what they are being treated to.

TP Scheme Road is 300 metres long, and one side of the road has a wall, one bounding the Adyar Poonga. It means there are habitations on only one side of the road.

A careless count puts it at 50; sparsely populated, one would expect serenity. And nature rearing up on one side meant the eyes have a pleasant object to focus on.

Here are the categories of "views" they are actually treated to on a daily basis, as listed by members of Poonga View RWA. Open urination along the wall. Unauthorised parking along the wall. When the TASMAL outlet was on Venkatakrishna Road in Mandaveli, tipplers would turn the space by the

wall into an open bar, and some of them would make it a "bed" for a stupefied, post-alcohol slumber. As reported by residents, there would also be other forms of substance abuse behind the illegally parked vehicles, some of them abandoned. Couples would also arrive in cars. Besides, the trees in the Poonga that were expected to give them a pleasant view, would ironically add to the problems. The leaves they shed, along with those shrugged off by the avenue trees on

TP Scheme Road, would accumulate by the side of the wall, as parked vehicles would mean the Urbaser Summer workers cannot clear the putrefying muck. There would be garbage as well, according to a member of the RWA. Repetiles feel at home in this muck.

This road falls in ward 171, Zone 13, and these residents have taken the matter to the councillor, and earlier even escalated it to the previous MLA.

And they are still waiting for all

these problems to be resolved.

This is how a member of Poonga View RWA puts it: "This has been the scene for many years with no action taken by the government even after many complaints to Greater Chennai Corporation. They keep pointing at the other officials for not doing their job. We want to bring this to the notice of CM Vijay so that there will be some action by the new government that could solve our long-pending problems."



In Nanmangalam, where a lake and a reserve forest are located cheek by jowl, the view may not be picture-perfect, being marred by garbage dumping and sewage inflow. But the picture is eye-catching as well, thanks to people's participation in improving conditions and its wildlife. Around International Day for Biological Diversity (May 22), a close look at the patch and its people

Between a lake and a forest

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

The health of a lake is directly proportional to the acts of positive reciprocity it receives from the people it serves. Its health is also predicated on the pride it instils in those people. The Nanmangalam lake is presented with a mixed bag. It is subjected to abuse by those in a position of stewardship towards it, but it also has two groups of people that make sure it stays in the news, its charms being extolled and its blights highlighted. And these groups vary in their composition, but have found a point of intersection where goals unite into something composite: preserving and cherishing the Nanmangalam lake.

Kumaresan Chandrabose is part of the local residents group, largely drawn from Sembakkam, Nanmangalam and Hastinapuram that has been documenting the biodiversity of the lake as well as the Nanmangalam Reserve forest that overlooks it, actually the rim of the forest. Through photography and videography, he has documented a wide range of resident and migratory species around the lake, as have most other members of this hyperlocal naturalist group. People outside this group also join nature walks.

According to Kumaresan, bird-watching has changed the way people view the lake.

The list of birds recorded at Nanmangalam is extensive. Among them are the Chestnut-winged Cuckoo, Asian Paradise

Flycatcher, Yellow Bittern, Painted Snipe, Black Bittern, Watercock, Long-toed Stint and Oriental Magpie Robin. Darters are also regularly spotted across the lake.

One species that particularly stands out is the Chestnut-winged Cuckoo, a migratory bird that has inked in Nanmangalam as its winter destination.

Kumaresan also described the Watercock as one of the more unusual birds found within Chennai Metropolitan area. Yellow Bittern nesting sites and Darter breeding activity have also been observed around the wetland. Interestingly, some migratory birds move into nearby

residential areas as well. The Blue-throated Blue Flycatcher, for instance, has been repeatedly spotted near

a temple inside a nearby apartment complex.

Beyond birds, he tracks butterflies and odonates around the lake, several of which have become harder to find.

A butterfly called the Joker, which depends on a native host plant called Tragia, locally known as Sendatti, is becoming scarce around the lake. Though the plant is often removed because it causes skin irritation, Kumaresan says it plays an important ecological role.

"In the name of beautification, many of these native bushes are being removed," he says.

Waste dumping is another negative factor.

No time to 'waste'

Over time, worsening environmental damage pushed a group of residents and volunteers to come together under the "Saving Nanmangalam Lake" initiative, a citizen-led movement launched in June 2024 to protect the lake and create awareness about its ecological

importance.

Among those leading these efforts are Jayapriya Ramanathan and R. Sathya, both residents of Sembakkam who have been actively involved in cleanup drives and awareness campaigns around the lake. According to organisers, untreated sewage inflow, encroachments, garbage dumping, and poor waste management remain some of the biggest threats facing the ecosystem today.

Another challenge, according to the organisers, is the lake's fragmented administration. Portions of the lake fall within the limits of different local civic bodies (in-

cluding the Tambaram Corporation), making coordinated restoration efforts challenging. "All the departments need to work together collectively," says Jayapriya, stressing that both the lake and adjoining reserve

forest require integrated protection measures.

A major concern is the garbage transit point established between the reserve forest and the lake by a panchayat. The site functions as a dumping and transportation area for municipal waste.

"We have seen cattle consuming plastic waste," says Sathya, adding that birds and other animals are also likely being affected by the pollution. This scenario makes biomagnification real.

Sathya also points out untreated sewage continues entering the waterbody.

In response, the initiative has focused heavily on community participation. Volunteers organise cleanup drives, awareness

campaigns, walkathons, meetings with officials, and waste segregation programmes. Residents are encouraged to reduce plastic usage, segregate waste properly and switch to cloth or jute bags.

A large awareness walkathon conducted earlier this year reportedly saw participation from nearly 600 volunteers.

Organisers say these efforts have started making a visible difference. In some stretches, garbage dumping has reduced, warning boards have been installed, and partial fencing work has been completed along the South Bund Road.

"Initially, many people believed nothing would change," Jayapriya says. "Gradually, public participation and awareness began to increase."

Though residents joined the initiative at different stages, the core volunteer group now consists of around 15 active members working consistently on the ground. Elderly residents who are unable to participate physically contribute through paperwork and coordination with government departments.

The movement has also expanded beyond the lake. Organisers recently formed the Vanam and Neer Foundation to support conservation efforts involving both the wetland and the Nanmangalam Reserve Forest.

Still, challenges remain. Waste often reappears after cleanup drives, and urban pressure around the lake continues to intensify. Conservation efforts, they say, cannot depend on volunteers alone.

Beauty and squalor coexist.

(Clockwise from top) An Oriental magpie robin in a pile of garbage; the dumping site; and a Painted snipe and a plastic discard. PHOTOS: KUMARESAN CHANDRABOSE & SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Advanced robotic surgery performed



▼ The team of surgeons and anaesthetists that performed the surgery.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A robotic nephrectomy was performed on a three-year-old child using the SSI Mantra 3, a robotic surgical platform at Murugan Hospital, Kilpauk.

The surgery was led by Dr. Raghul M, a paediatric surgeon, along with assistant surgeon Dr. Sabari, and supported by SSI Mantra robotic technician Vishal Pandian. The anaesthesia team was headed by Dr. Karthikeyan.

According to a release,

the child had been suffering from recurrent urinary tract infections due to a rare congenital urological abnormality – a non-functioning left kidney associated with a grossly dilated and tortuous ectopic ureter draining into the vagina.

Using robotic-assisted minimally invasive surgery, the diseased kidney and abnormal ureter were removed through tiny incisions. The procedure was completed successfully in approximately one hour,

with minimal blood loss and excellent intraoperative stability, the release added.

Dr. Raghul said, “Robotic technology is gradually transforming the way complex paediatric surgical procedures are performed. In young children, precision becomes extremely important due to limited working space and delicate anatomical structures.”

The hospital is located on Kilpauk Garden Road. Phone: 044 4644 8989.

A passion for excellence



A. Farheen Sultana at the Annai Veilankanni's College of Arts and Science, Saidapet.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A. Farheen Sultana, a student, has overcome adversity through her dedication to excellence. She was the school topper in the Standard X Board examinations and again in XII, scoring 586 out of 600.

Honoring her brilliance and relentless hard work, Annai Veilankanni's College of Arts and Science, Saidapet, has admit-

ted her to the B. Com (General) program and a CA course, awarding her a 100 per cent full-fee-waiver scholarship.

Despite severe financial hardship, Farheen has proven that education is very important for girls and has changed her own destiny; she is inspiring generations to come.



Tree planting at Jeeva Park

A tree planting drive was organised at Jeeva Park in T. Nagar recently. According to a press release, it was organised by Rotary Club of Chennai Triumph. The event was aimed at spreading awareness about the importance of improving green cover.

Lakshmi Nrusimha Jayanthi celebration



Visankirtali Trust organised a three-day Lakshmi Nrusimha Jayanthi festival from May 8 to 10 at Shri Kanchi Mahaswamy Anantha Mandapam, Adyar.

According to a press release, bhajans, namasankirtanam, Carnatic music concert, discourse, recitation of slokas, and annadhaanam marked the event.

Visankirtali Trust has been conducting the festival for 25 years in Delhi before moving to Chennai in 2022 and this is the fifth year celebration in Chennai, adds the release.

It was founded by V P Shastrighal in 1969. His son, “Delhi Shri” Shankar Bhagavathar, administers the trust as its managing trustee.

Visankirtali Trust is at Block 4, Flat 3-I, Ceebros Shyamala Gardens, Arcot Road, Saligramam. Phone: 8800600566 / 9312255913



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Space in Arumbakkam open for events

Parivarthan for Parkinson's Foundation, a non-profit working to improve the quality of life for people affected by Parkinson's, offers free supportive care therapies at its centre in Arumbakkam on weekdays.

Parivarthan is offering this space to like-minded communities to use on weekends/ weekday evenings. This can be for small events, movie screenings (weekends), or classes by artists and musicians (weekday

evenings). The main hall can accommodate between 20 and 25 people comfortably, said a release. Charges for use of the space will be nominal to cover cleaning, electricity, and any other miscellaneous expenses, added the release.

Interested organisations/persons can contact 9381035979 for more details.

Parivarthan for Parkinson's Foundation is at New No. 16, Old No. 9 Razack Garden Road, Arumbakkam

Four-week Yoga programme

Satyananda Yoga Centre is conducting a four-week Yoga programme in K.K. Nagar, Mambakkam, Madambakkam, Nanganallur, and Velachery. Time: From 5.30 a.m. to 7 a.m. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. The

centre follows the curriculum of Bihar School of Yoga. Recitation of slokas and mantras are part of the programme, adds the release. For date and venue details, call 8754499334 / 6383008358 / 9841227709 / 9176902929.

Session on organic farming



Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is organising a culinary workshop on making soups on May 27. According to a press release, the programme will have demonstrations on preparations of soups from tubers, greens, herbs, and millets.

Another workshop on organic farming of vegetable crops will be held on May 29. The session will fo-

cus on chemical-free methods of soil nourishment and pest and disease management.

The essentials and procedure of organic certification will be taught, adds the release. Both the workshops will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy.

For details, call 044 - 29530048

Quiz for middle-school students

Chennai-based KSA Trust is inviting school teams for the second edition of 'Quiz Champions of Chennai - 2026'. Curated by expert quiz masters, this event is designed to educate and engage middle-school students by sharing champion stories and diverse areas of knowledge.

The 2025 event had 28 schools and 1,550 students participating in it. Winners received certificates, gift vouchers, and a plaque for their school.

Founded by the 30-year-old Chennai-based Chartered Accounting firm Kalyanasundaram

Associates, since 2013 KSA Trust has been running its annual 'Champions of Chennai Awards, where it honour individuals and organisations in Chennai who have made remarkable contribu-

tions across fields such as arts, education, healthcare, enterprise, social initiative, science, and sports. These are people who serve selflessly, often without recognition, yet profoundly impact our community, said a release.

It has recognised 77 such champions to date, and August 17, 2026, will mark its 13th year, added the release.

To learn more, please visit: www.championsofchennai.org

For any questions regarding the quiz, email rao@championsofchennai.org or call 98411 16216.



Guided heritage walk



If you are yet to take a visit to the renovated Victoria Public Hall then do book a slot.

The Greater Chennai Corporation has an online booking facility for a guided heritage walk of the building, near Central Square, for tourists and residents.

Visitors will get to know the history, architecture, and heritage of the place. Individuals, families, schools, colleges, and organisations are welcome to be part of these walks.

For details, visit <https://gccservices.in/victoriapublichall>

Free workshop on postcard writing

The Madras Postcrossing Commune is conducting a free training workshop on postcard writing on May 24 at the premises of Kin Technologies, Anna Salai; from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m.

During this workshop, the art of postcard writing including its significance and practical methods of usage will be explained in detail. The organisers intend to raise awareness regarding 'World Turtle Day' (May 23) by releasing a special postcard.

There is no age limit for participating in this workshop. Prior registration is mandatory to participate in the workshop. To register or for further details, contact 7448523232 or 8667494269.

The Madras Postcrossing Commune is a voluntary organisation dedicated to promoting the practice of postcard writing.

MSME conducts skill training

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Tamil Nadu is organising a training programme on making chemical products. The products include: black phenyl, grease, disinfectants, and detergents meant for cleaning and washing floor, water tank, pipes, utensils, and clothes. The session will be held from May 25 to 27.

The institute is also conducting another workshop on making value-added products from Moringa. The session will be held on May 29.

This includes ready-to-cook products such as tea powder, soup powder, health drink powder, noodles, idli flour, chapathi flour, and adai flour. Also ready-to-eat products such as biscuits, cookies, drumstick leaf powder, and pickle. Further, preparation of hair oil and skincare oil will be demonstrated, says a press release.

Both the programmes will be



Photo used for representational purpose only.

held at the institute's premises at EDII Office Road, Ekkattuthangal. For details, call 8668102600 / 78069 18309.



Cultural events at Vadapalani temple

The Vaikasi Visakam Brahmotsavam will be celebrated at the Arulmigu Vadapalani Andavar Temple, Vadapalani, from June 1 to 10. According to a press release, Sri Krishna Sweets will be organising various events at the festival. They include, music and discourse, adds the release.